

16 Windwalker Way

Tustin Legacy, Tustin, CA 92782 · Prepared for the designer · Compiled July 26, 2026

4 Bed / 3 Bath · ≈2,666 sq ft · Built 2016 · Greenwood at Tustin Legacy · Craftsman-Farmhouse tract elevation

Property listing: [redfin.com/CA/Tustin/16-Windwalker-Way-92782](https://www.redfin.com/CA/Tustin/16-Windwalker-Way-92782)

WHO YOU'D BE WORKING WITH

About Us

We go by Vino (short for Vinothini) and Ravi (Dushyant Ravichandran). We're a couple in our early thirties, both working professionals, and this is our first home, so this brief may be more detailed than it strictly needs to be.

We're both originally from India. Ravi moved to the U.S. at 17. I grew up in the Middle East, spent a few years in India, then over a decade in Singapore, before landing in the U.S. Between the two of us we've picked up a real mix of cultures along the way, and we want the home to reflect that instead of picking just one.

We've watched more than our fair share of Architectural Digest home tours together, so between the two of us we like to think we have an above-average sense of style, we know what we like when we see it, even if we can't always name it ourselves.

I work from home and am very much a homebody. We both love to cook, and we want a home that's set up for real hosting, family visits us several times a year, and those visits should feel easy, not cramped.

We're hoping to start a family soon, and we'd rather get ahead of that now than retrofit the house later. That's a big part of why kid life shows up throughout this brief, we want it to feel naturally built in from day one.

Our litmus test is whether we can work color and eclectic pieces into the home tastefully and intentionally, not randomly. If we've gotten it right, a stray primary-colored toy left on the floor shouldn't feel out of place.

Overall, we're hoping for a home that feels elevated but cozy, personal, and honest about who we are and everywhere we've lived along the way. Not a showroom.

Our Ask

Thanks for taking the time to look through this, we know it's a lot to cover. We're planning to source materials and run the contractors ourselves, so what we're hoping to get is the vision, the game plan, and the finish selections, the creative and design thinking, not the day-to-day construction management.

BUDGET

We can't give a fixed number just yet, but here's the general philosophy: spend where it really matters, be thoughtful where it doesn't. Materials should hold up over time and feel good, not cheap, but we're not precious about it, if there's a budget-friendly option that still looks and feels right, that works too. Medium range is a reasonable assumption for most of the house.

ALREADY IN MOTION, SEPARATELY

A contractor and architect are already handling the California room enclosure and the wider sliders (see that card below), so no need to take that on. Thoughts on materials or layout there are still welcome.

TWO OPEN LAYOUT QUESTIONS

Laid out with photos in the Entrance & Stairway card, [jump to Room-by-Room](#): how might we give the **foyer-to-living-room ceiling** a bit more sense of arrival, and should the **entrance flooring** shift to tile or stone, or just let the wood run through? Open to ideas on both.

Here's roughly where we could use help, no pressure to have answers for all of it right away:

- Finishes: tile, countertops, backsplash, the right flooring
- Wood, cabinetry color, baseboard
- Wall treatment, brick accent or subtle panelling, and where it might actually make sense
- Ceiling treatment and a lighting plan, room by room
- Kitchen and bathroom form and function
- Where the prayer corner might go
- A color and material palette for the whole house
- Furniture and art/décor direction, room by room
- Built-in storage, designed with a kid in mind
- Wall paint, type and colors
- Non-toxic materials wherever that feels realistic

DELIVERABLE FORMAT

Since contractors will be handled directly, it would help to eventually have: a mood board with the color/material palette, a 3D rendering of the approved design, and spec sheets thorough enough to bid and build from, materials, finishes, dimensions, SKUs where relevant. Open to discussing what's reasonable and how to get there.

VISION, STANDARDS & DÉCOR GUARDRAILS

Vision & Design Standards

A warm, practical, globally inspired family home with natural materials, kid-friendly comfort, simple smart technology, and intentional Indian accents that add personality without overwhelming the space.

80%

MODERN / GLOBAL

20%

INDIAN ACCENTS

This is the ratio for the whole house, not just art. Furniture, lighting, textiles, objects, should all read modern-global first, with Indian pieces woven in as personal touches.

Basic idea: keep the shell quiet so the layered, colorful stuff on top can actually stand out. It's the same trick the Craftsman-Farmhouse exterior already pulls off, calm enough that it doesn't fight for attention. Elevated should feel warm, never like a hotel lobby. And if a kid's toy or a stray towel ends up on the floor, it shouldn't clash with the room, that's basically the test for whether the palette is working.

WOOD TONES

- White oak, walnut, off-white/beige, mixed but cohesive across cabinetry, doors, baseboards. They just need to not clash.

HARDWARE & WINDOWS

- Finish can vary room to room. Just steer clear of gold and that flat builder-grade matte black.
- Switch plates consistent throughout. Window frames stay beige everywhere.

WALLS & PAINT

- Should read as a clean backdrop for the art and décor, not compete with it. Non-toxic, low-VOC, easy-clean.
- A few brick or panelling moments here and there, see Room-by-Room for where.

LIGHTING

- Warm and layered. Recessed is okay in small doses, just don't overdo it or make it harsh.
- Alexa-compatible. Cables and wiring hidden wherever that's realistic.

COMFORT & TECH

- Remote shades and curtains, water-leak sensors, hidden plugs and router.

DÉCOR DIRECTION

- Layered over matchy. Use pattern freely. One antique or vintage piece per major room.
- Gallery-style art, one bold piece to anchor it. Sculptural lighting instead of anything builder-grade.
- Natural materials wherever they make sense. Kids' art gets displayed, not tucked away.

OUR SCOPE + DESIGNER'S DIRECTION, COMBINED

Room-by-Room Direction

Each card shows the room as it looks today, then splits things into **Function** (what it needs to do) and **Form** (how it should feel). None of this is meant to box you in, more a starting point for a conversation. Anything flagged "open question" is us genuinely wanting your take, not a decision we've already made, see "Our Ask" for the full rundown.

Entrance & Stairway

Sets the tone for everything else

CURRENT STATE



The entrance and foyer, looking through to the great room

FUNCTION	FORM
• Slip-resistant treads, a sturdy handrail that's comfortable to grip, closed risers • Step lighting, but subtle, please no visible LED strip • A console or credenza that can hold shoes	• New stair railing that matches the home's flooring • An antique or patterned runner starting a few steps up • A full-length mirror somewhere in here • One statement art piece, one statement light fixture • Brick accent along the stairway if it's doable

OPEN QUESTION: ENTRY FLOORING

We keep going back and forth: a tile or stone moment right at the entry, or just let the wood run straight through from the door? Check [Foyer inspiration ↓](#) for a couple of tile-inset and herringbone examples we liked.

OPEN QUESTION: FOYER-TO-LIVING-ROOM CEILING

Right now it's just one flat ceiling running from the entry into the great room, so there's no real sense of arrival. We've been thinking an arched opening or some kind of ceiling moment (a beam, a drop, a coffer) could fix that, but honestly open to other ideas. [Foyer inspiration ↓](#) has a few arched-opening and recessed-ceiling examples.

See inspiration: [Foyer ↓](#) · [Stairway ↓](#) · [Panelling & brick moments ↓](#)

Living / Great Room

Where everyone actually hangs out

CURRENT STATE



Living and dining, one open run



Closer on the seating area

FUNCTION	FORM
• Serious toy storage, we mean it • Seating that can actually take daily wear and tear • The sofa back faces the dining side, so it'd be nice if it looked intentional there, not like the back of a sofa • Air purifier and dehumidifier worked into the furniture, not sitting out as appliances • Hide the cables	• TV placed thoughtfully, anchored by a good console, maybe low benches or cushioned seats flanking it instead of a big built-in wall • A sofa that feels elevated rather than sunken and tired, but still one we'll actually want to sit on • A couple of accent chairs • Furniture that reads collected over time, not like it all came from one catalog • A rug that anchors the room's pattern • Window treatments that give it a cozy, layered feel • That long flat ceiling needs some depth, maybe a low-profile coffered treatment, see Coffered Ceiling & Panelling inspiration ↓

See inspiration: [Living ↓](#) · [Coffered Ceiling & Panelling ↓](#)

California Room & Widened Sliders

The indoor/outdoor connection

CURRENT STATE



The back patio right now, pavers and a small covered nook by the sliders, this whole area is getting enclosed

We've already got a contractor and architect on the enclosure and the wider sliders, so this one's off your plate structurally, though we'd love your input on materials or layout. Once it's built out, the plan is to run the same flooring through with no threshold break, so it feels like part of the house instead of a patio bolted on.

FUNCTION	FORM
• Wider sliders and a full enclosure, structural work already in progress • Flooring runs straight through, no threshold break • Ceiling fan or heater built in cleanly, no visible box units	• Woven or rattan furniture and warm textiles that bridge indoor and outdoor

Kitchen/Dining

The room that gets used the most

CURRENT STATE



Kitchen, dining, and the stairway, all one open run



The island, and the slider out to the patio

FUNCTION	FORM
• There's already a separate pantry room, so build the storage plan around that instead of starting from zero • Toe space under the island and sink, bottom drawers instead of lower cabinets, rotating corner shelving, an appliance garage • Deep shelving, vertical tray storage, deep utensil drawers, dedicated produce storage • A hood that can actually keep up with Indian cooking, induction cooktop, pull-out trash/recycling/compost • Under-cabinet lighting, but subtle, no visible LED strip • Hot and filtered water taps, a pantry outlet for appliance charging, step-stool storage (built in or just a stool that lives somewhere) • Somewhere to keep the cleaning supplies • A message center, mail, keys, calendar, either here or in the mudroom • Appliances hidden where it makes sense, but not so buried that pulling them out becomes a whole thing • Paper towel roll out of sight but still within reach	• Seamless sink edge, rounded corners on the island and counters • Open to a full-slab backsplash matching the counter, or tile, whatever looks best in the end • Uppers that go floor-to-ceiling, glass-front at the top for displaying pretty things • Would love if it felt like a kitchen where Indian utensils, patterned hand towels, and good china can just live out in the open • Open to integrated or panelled appliances, but not a requirement • Not big on floating shelves generally, except maybe the small stretch near the sliding doors, that could be nice for a decorative one • Would love for the dining table and chairs to feel spacious and look good, not like an afterthought squeezed in • Countertop, backsplash tile, and cabinetry color are all still open, that's part of what we need your help with

See inspiration: [Kitchen ↓](#)

Bathrooms

Accessible, but shouldn't feel clinical about it

CURRENT STATE



Secondary bathroom, the shower stall



Secondary bathroom, vanity between two bedrooms



Primary bathroom, dual vanity and tub

FUNCTION	FORM
• Anti-slip materials, grip bars that match the rest of the hardware, a bench in the wet area • Would love to skip sliding shower doors where we can, hinged glass with an anti-slip coating instead, and no shower curtains • A handheld shower head would be great, ideally not fixed-only • Bidets on the toilets • A product niche, but positioned so it's not the first thing you see walking in • Somewhere hidden or built-in for toilet paper and trash, even a concealed movable bin works • An actual spot to hang towels • Quiet exhaust fan with a humidity sensor, tied into the smart-home system	• Freestanding tub in the primary • Mirrors with some personality, not the plain builder-grade rectangle • Fine with a mix of large-format and smaller tile, as long as it's easy to keep clean • Invisible or linear drain, and a built-in bench if we can swing it, otherwise even just a ledge to rest a leg on while shaving • Tile and surfaces are still open, part of what we need help deciding

See inspiration: [Bathroom](#) ↓

Guest Room

Staged as an office right now, function is still open

CURRENT STATE



The bay-window bedroom, staged as an office for the listing photos

FUNCTION	FORM
• Would love for it to work as a comfortable overnight room for guests, storage and layout are still TBD	• Same wood tone and 80/20 modern-Indian direction as the rest of the house • Everything else here is open, part of the finishes ask

Nursery

Cozy and a little fun, not its own separate world

CURRENT STATE



Potential nursery, exact room hasn't been decided yet

FUNCTION	FORM
- Room for diaper changing - Crib - Nursing chair - A lot of storage for clothes and toys	- Would love for it to feel like part of the house's palette and materials, not a separate style zone - Fun, toy-friendly, please nothing too neutral or greige

See inspiration: [Nursery ↓](#)

Prayer Corner

A personal touch, location still undecided

CANDIDATE LOCATION



The landing on the way up to the primary bedroom, one option we're considering

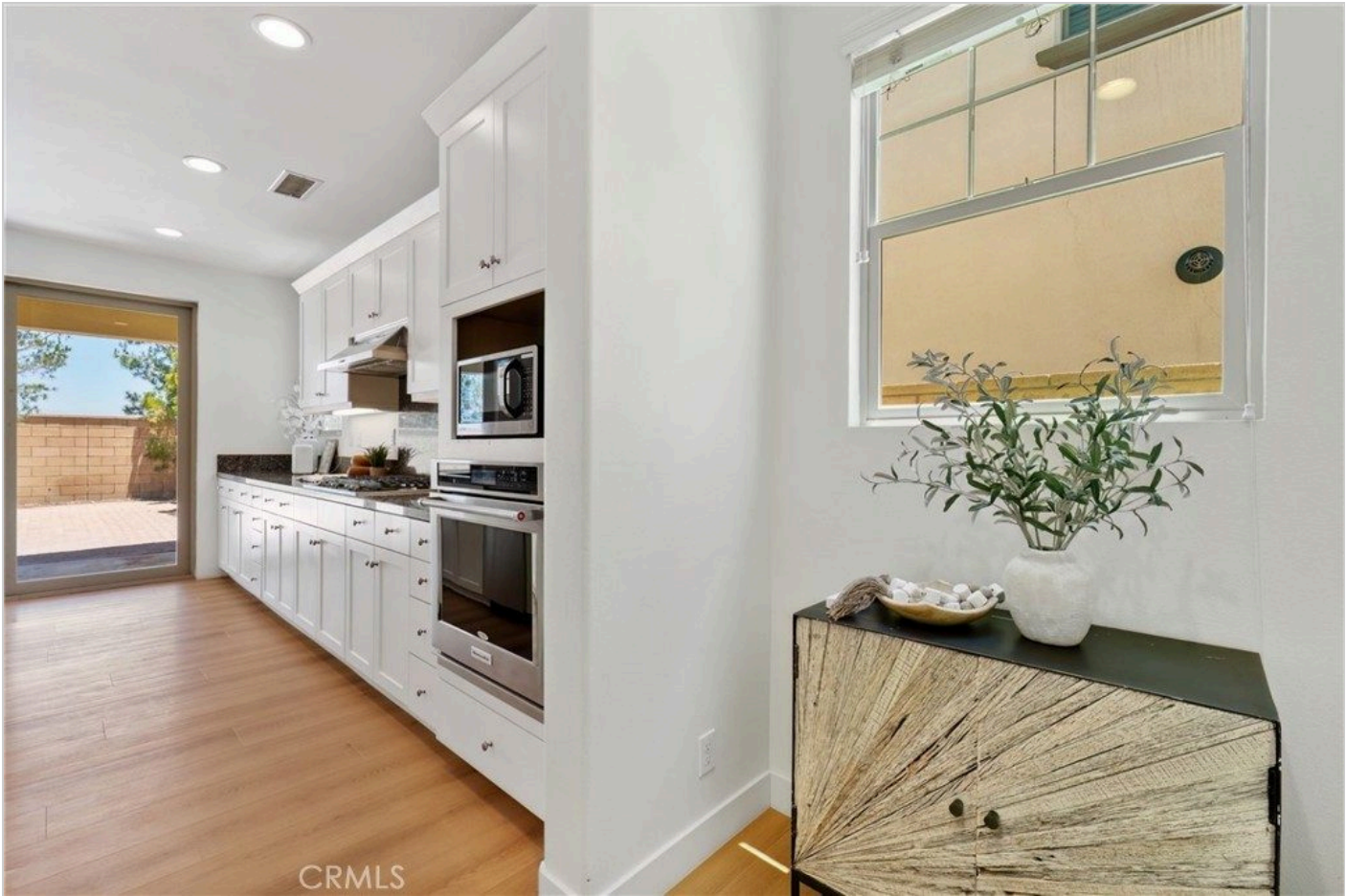
FUNCTION	FORM
• A built-in alcove, or even just a freestanding piece, doesn't need to be a full room • Closed storage underneath so the surface stays curated • If it ends up on that landing wall, only a small portion of the wall, not the whole thing • We're still open to other spots, would love your read on where it actually belongs	• Subtle, should blend into the rest of the modern transitional décor rather than becoming its own moment • A small ledge, warm dimmable lighting on its own scene

See inspiration: [Prayer Corner](#) ↓

Mudroom

Basically an extension of the kitchen

CURRENT STATE



The nook off the kitchen, we're hoping to keep that window

FUNCTION	FORM
• A bench for putting shoes on and off, open shelving or closed cubbies underneath, hooks above • A real landing spot for keys, mail, bags, the stuff that always ends up on the kitchen counter otherwise • A tall cabinet, hidden, for cleaning tools, hooks for the mop/broom/vacuum, shelves above for supplies • We're hoping to keep that existing window, so the cabinetry would need to work around it	• Floor-to-ceiling cabinetry, and a cushioned bench with drawers underneath feels a lot warmer than open slats • Durable, easy-clean flooring matching the entry • A statement pendant light, woven baskets in any open cubbies

See inspiration: [Mudroom ↓](#)

Tech Desk (Stairway Landing)

A small work nook, not a full room

CURRENT STATE



The window nook at the landing, there's a bench there now, this is where the desk would go

FUNCTION	FORM
• A built-in or floating desk, deep enough for a laptop or monitor, with a real task chair • Drawers under the desk, open shelving or a small bookcase alongside • Cables hidden	• Warm wood tone, matching the rest of the house • Keep it light so it still feels like it belongs next to the seating nook it's replacing • Subtle lighting, cove or under-shelf, nothing harsh

See inspiration: [Tech Desk](#) ↓

Lounge

The upstairs hangout spot

CURRENT STATE



The lounge/loft space as it is now

FUNCTION	FORM
• Comfortable everyday seating, good enough for movie nights without needing a whole media wall • A low console with storage for books and toys • Cables hidden	• Relaxed, layered textiles • A low console beats a big built-in wall here • Kid-friendly, happy to have a gallery wall of art or the kids' own pieces

See inspiration: [Lounge](#) ↓

Laundry Room

Utility

CURRENT STATE



The laundry room as it is now

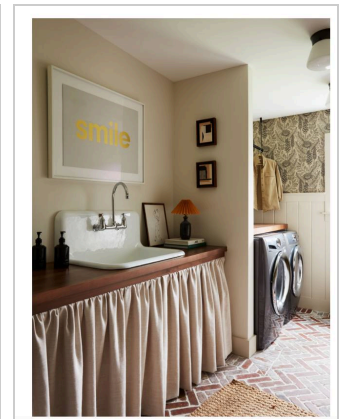
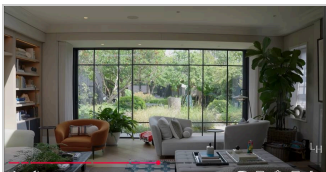
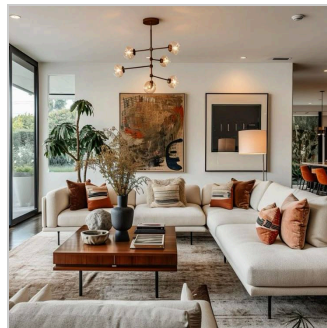
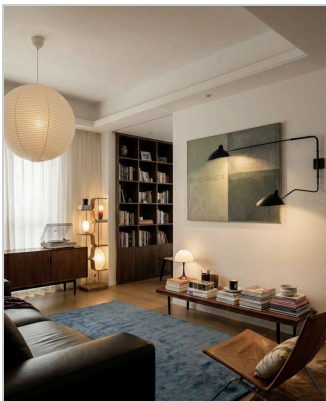
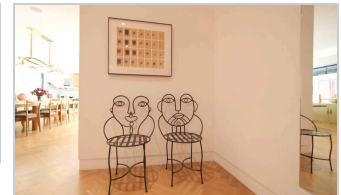
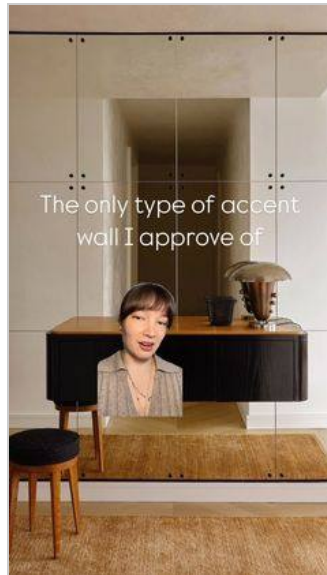
FUNCTION	FORM
• Washer and dryer • Room to iron and steam • Storage for the tall stuff, mop, vacuum, broom	• Would love for it to feel warm and inviting, not like a cold utility closet

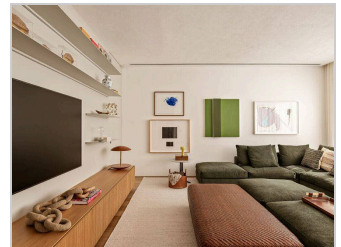
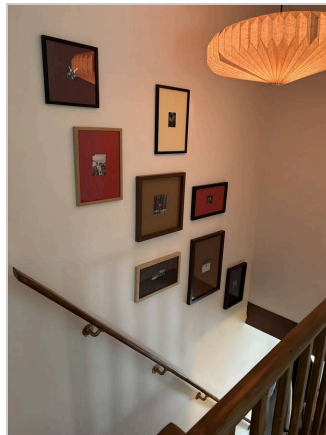
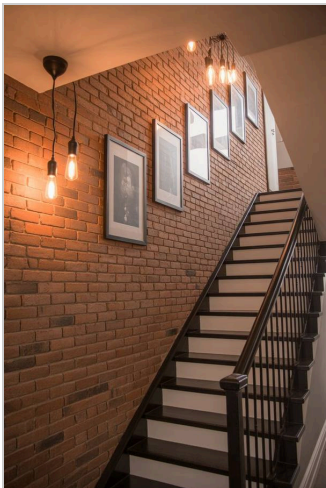
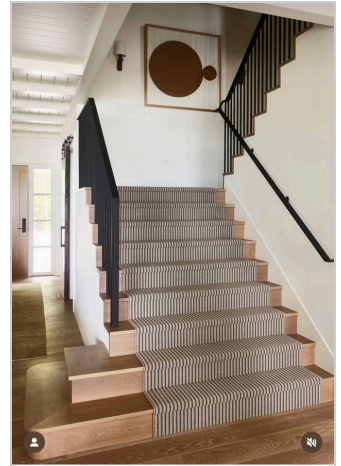
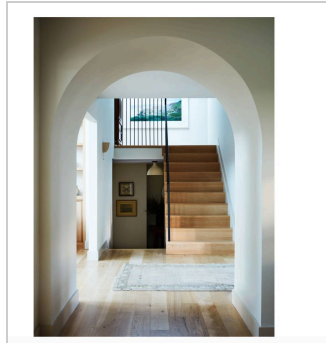
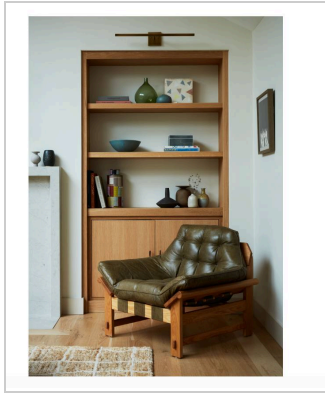
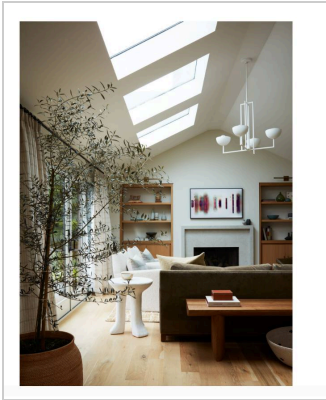
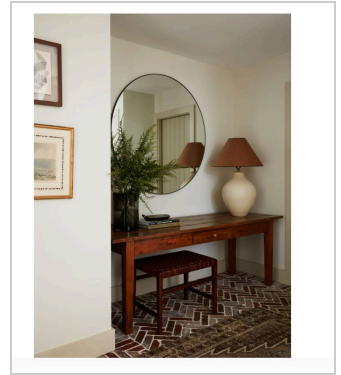
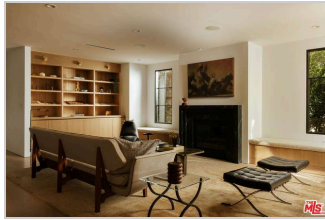
See inspiration: [Laundry ↓](#)

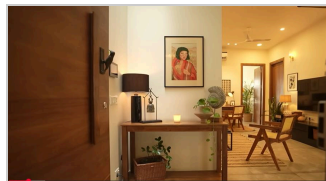
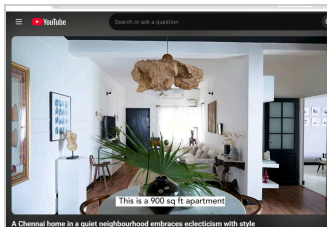
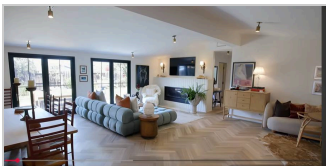
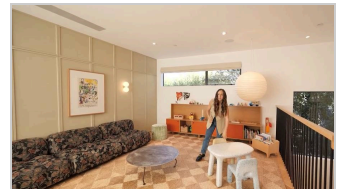
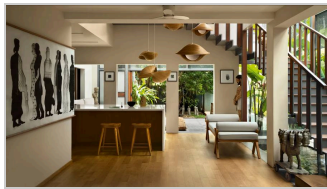
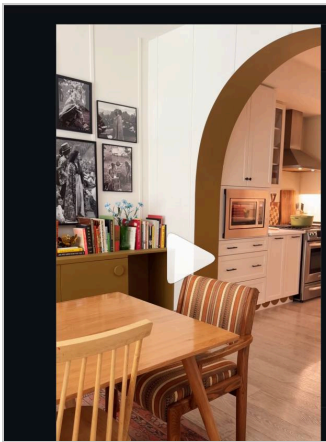
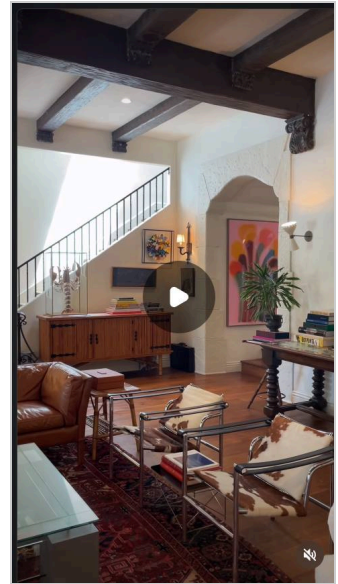
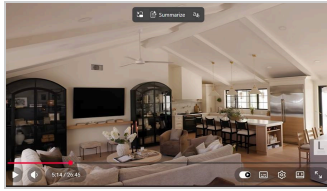
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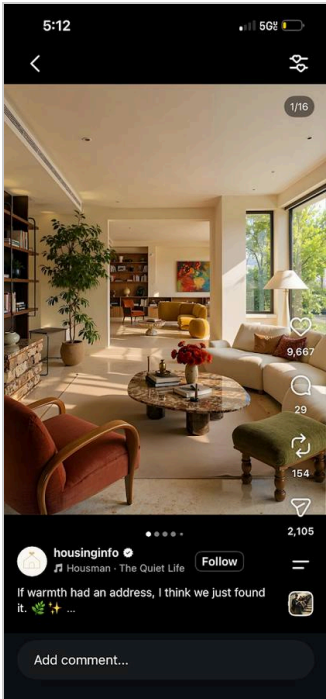
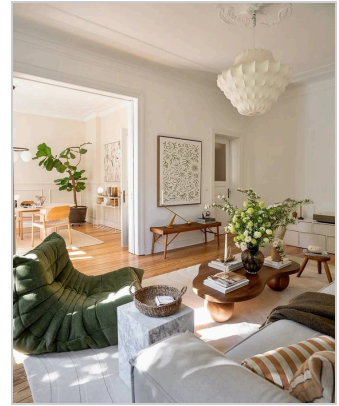
General Vibe Moodboard

The full moodboard. Warm, textured, feels collected over time, nothing showroom-matched.







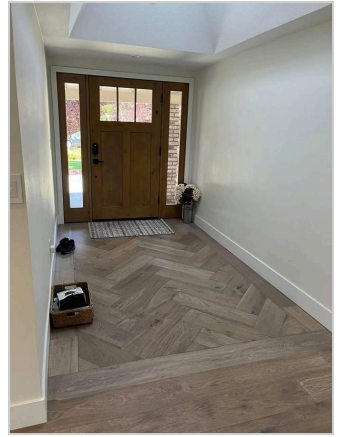
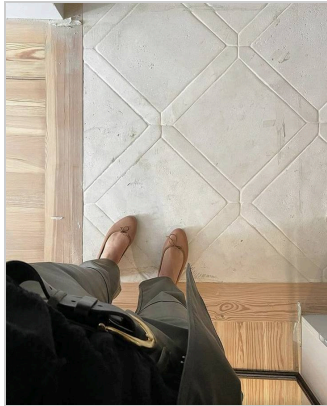


SOURCE MATERIAL · ROOM SPECIFIC INSPO.DOCX + FOYER.DOCX

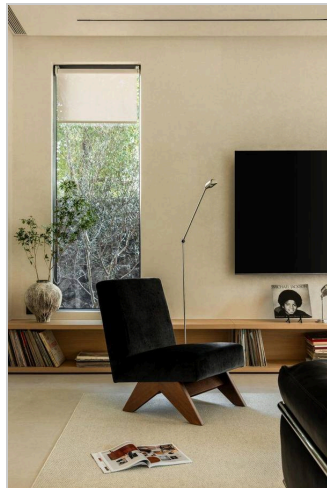
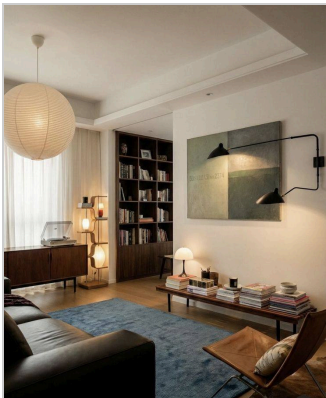
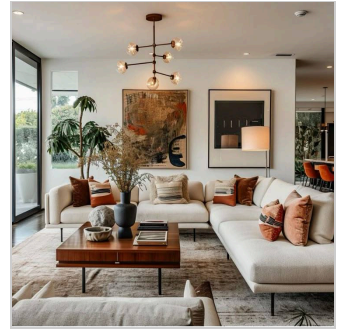
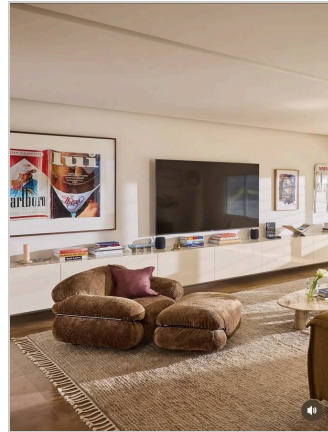
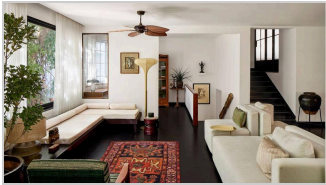
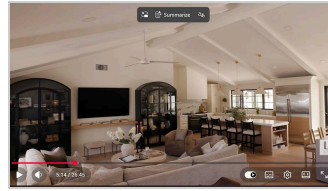
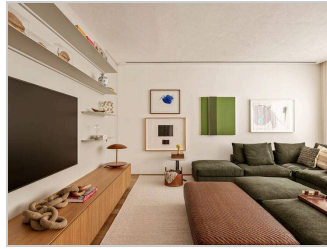
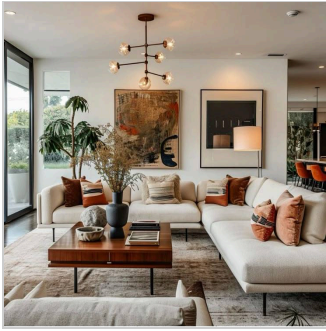
Room-Specific Inspiration

These are aesthetic references, mood and material, not the functional stuff, that's in Room-by-Room Direction above.

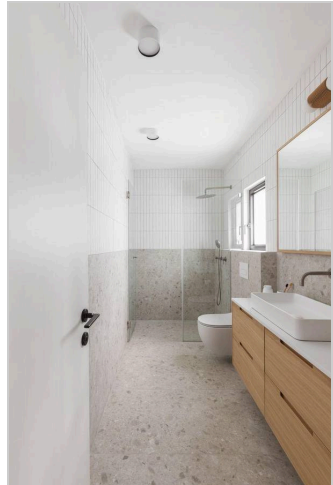
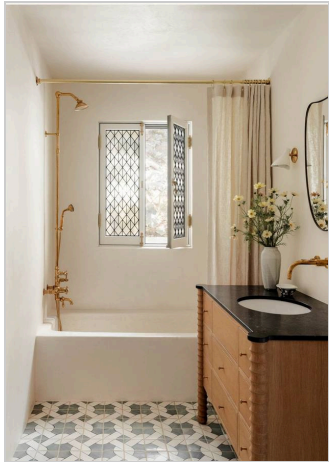
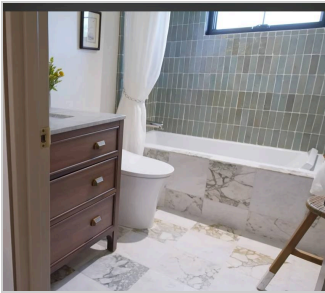
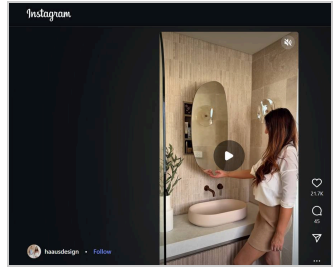
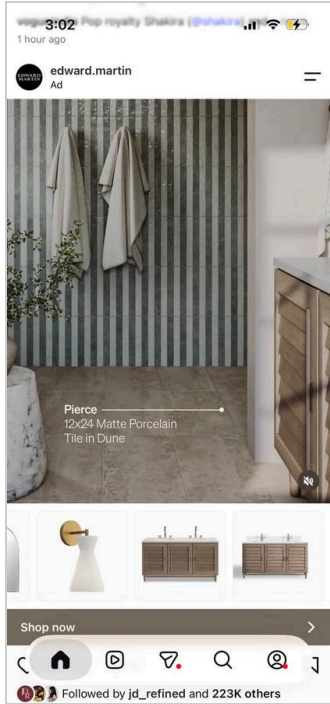
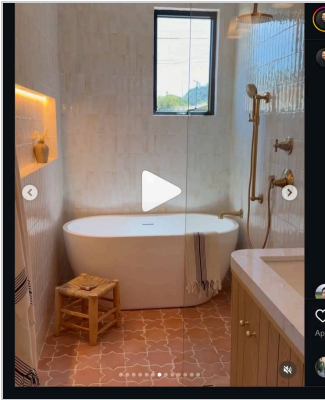
FOYER



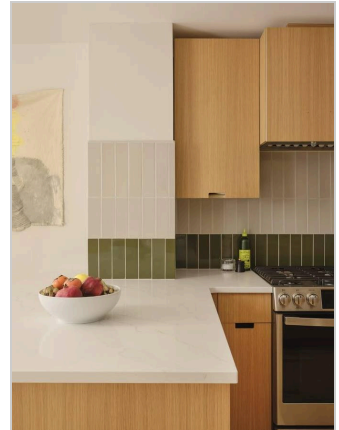
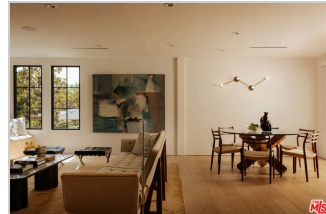
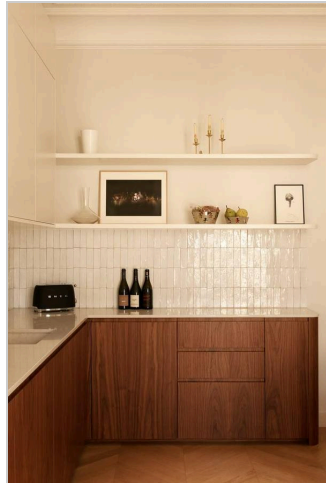
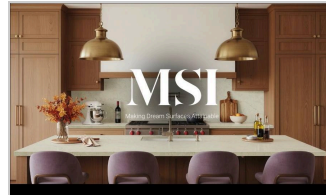
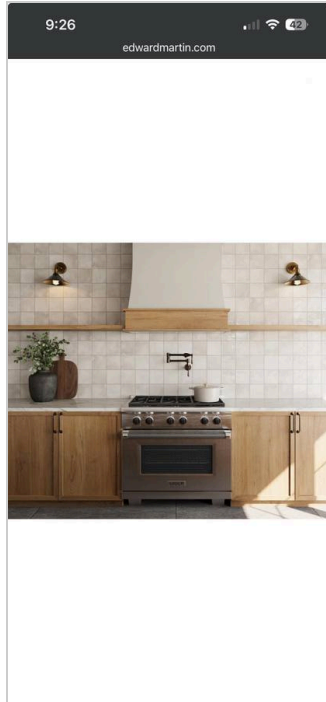
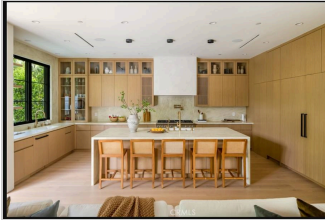
LIVING



BATHROOM



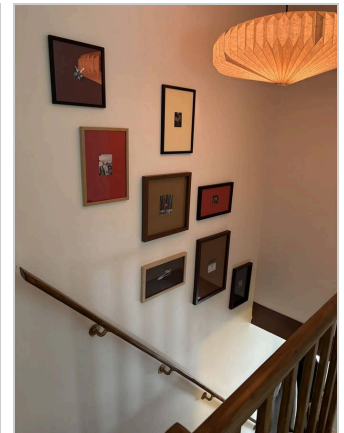
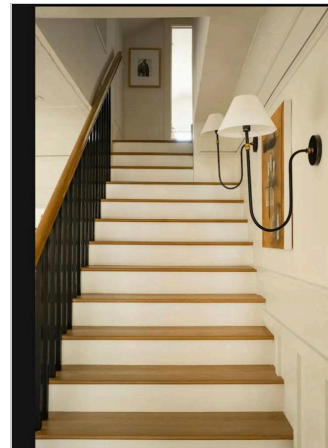
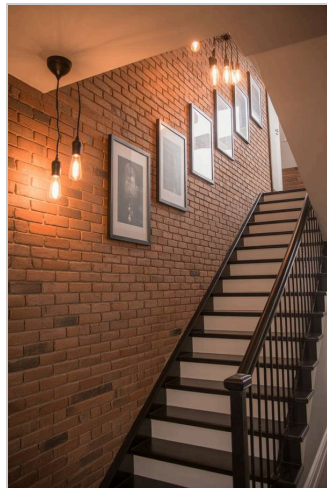
KITCHEN



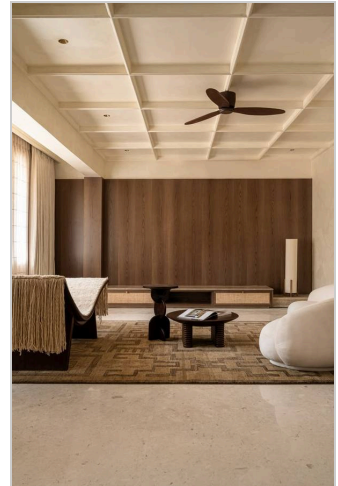
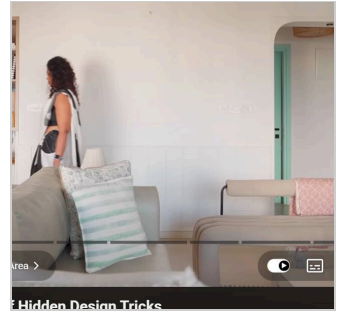
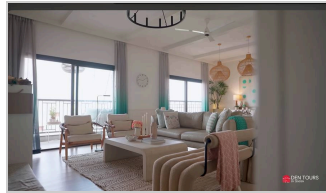
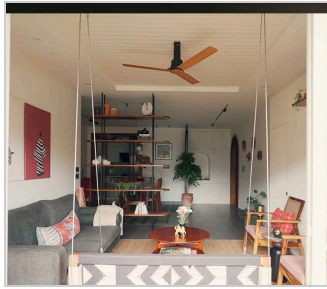
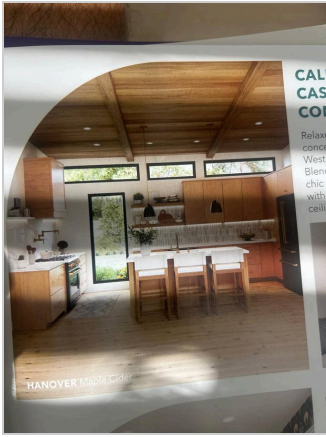
PRAYER CORNER



STAIRWAY



COFFERED CEILING/PANELLING



MUDROOM



LAUNDRY



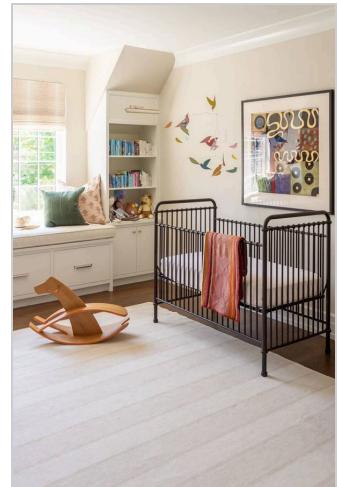
TECH DESK



LOUNGE



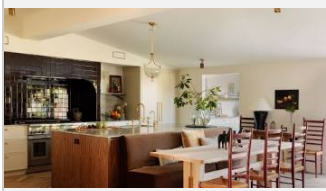
NURSERY



Reference Home Tours

Full home tours we pointed to as tonal references. Click through to watch.

ELEVATED YET COZY WITH PERSONALITY

Link only	 HOMEWORTHY	Link only	
At Home in New Jersey with Designer Kelli Suozzo of BOWERBIRD Rue	HOUSE TOUR An Artistic and Eclectic Home in Washington, DC 4K	(2) Instagram	1714 Labrador Drive in Mesa Verde Costa Mesa
Link only	 #OnceUponACottageProj HOUSE TOUR	 Open Door AD	 HOME TOUR OAKS PROJECT SM THE STUDIO
Inside Maple Adams-Krygier Contemporary Classical Home in Washington, D.C.	Full House Tour of Our Latest Phoenix Renovation THELIFESTYLEDCO #OnceUponACottageProj	Inside Amber Valletta's Peaceful L.A. Sanctuary Open Door Architectural Digest	The Oaks Project Home Tour Seamlessly Blending Modern and Traditional Styles

MIX OF WESTERN AND INDIAN

Link only	 DIY HOMES Roshika @sage.and.lilly.home	 DIY HOMES Ft. Vinithra
Chennai home tour	9. Inside Roshika's (@sage.and.lilly.home) Modern Bohemian Home In Gurgaon That Is Full Of Plants 🌸🌟 - plants, wooden doors and brick layering	Inside Vinithra's Scandinavian Style Inspired Home In Bengaluru 💕 n